

THE UPGRADE MAP

Copywriter is a skill.

Creative Strategist is a business.

Level 1: Copywriter

You write what you're told to write.

Clients give you a brief. You deliver words.

Rate: \$200–\$500 per project

Level 2: Copy + Creative Strategy

You write what the research tells you to write.

You bring angles, insight, audience truth.

Rate: \$1,500–\$3,000 per project

Level 3: Full Creative Strategist

You decide what gets written at all.

You own angle, brief, copy, results.

Rate: \$3K–\$10K retainer

The gap isn't writing skill

It's:

- Research methodology
- Market awareness
- Offer thinking
- Taste

You don't get to Level 2 by writing more

**You get there by reading ads, doing teardowns,
understanding WHY winners win.**

Then writing like you saw something they didn't.

Stuck at Level 1?

Comment UPGRADE for the 3-week plan.

Follow @csos for creative strategy breakdowns.